

ECON 101 Discussion Section

Week 6. Sampling Distributions

- **Population:** The total set of subjects in which we are interested.
- **Sample:** Subset of the population for whom we have data.
- A **population parameter** is a numerical summary of the population.
- A **sample statistic** is a numerical summary of a sample taken from the population.
- The **sampling distribution** of a statistic is the probability distribution that specifies probabilities for the possible values the statistic can take.

Numerical summary	Population	Sample (size of n)
Mean	μ	$\bar{X}$
Standard Deviation	σ	s
Proportion	p	$\hat{p}$

*A sample should be randomly chosen!

If we repeat the random sampling and calculate a sample statistic each time, we are very likely to have different values! i.e., We get a sampling distribution of the sample statistic. And, if the sample statistic is normally distributed, we can use empirical rules and z-scores to calculate a probability!

Sample Mean $\bar{X}$

The **sampling distribution** of the sample mean ($\bar{X}$) is

- (1) normally distributed *if a population distribution (X) is normally distributed, OR*
- (2) approximately normally distributed *if a population distribution is not a normal distribution, but the sample size is large enough! ($n \geq 30$)* “Central Limit Theorem (CLT)”

When the distribution of sample mean $\bar{X}$ is normally distributed,

the **mean** of $\bar{X}$: μ

the **standard deviation** of $\bar{X}$: $\frac{\sigma}{\sqrt{n}}$

Sample Proportion $\hat{p}$

p : proportion of times that $x=1$ in the entire population.

$\hat{p}$: proportion of times that $x=1$ in a sample.

If np and $n(1-p)$ are at least 15, the **sampling distribution** of a sample proportion is approximately a normal distribution.

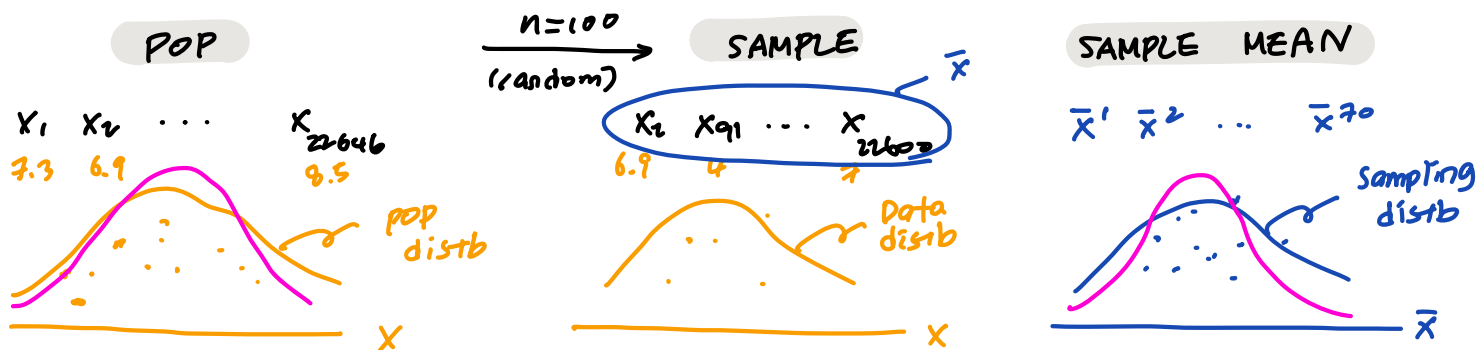
For a random sample of size n from a population with proportion p ,

the **mean** of $\hat{p}$: p

the **standard deviation** of $\hat{p}$: $\sqrt{\frac{p(1-p)}{n}}$

22,646 UCR undergrads

Q1 $X = \text{hrs of sleep}$



mean $\mu = \frac{X_1 + X_2 + \dots + X_{22646}}{N}$
 $N \leftarrow 22646$

$\bar{X} = \frac{X_2 + \dots + X_{22600}}{n}$
 $n \leftarrow 100$

mean of $\bar{X} = \mu$

sd $\sigma = \sqrt{\frac{(X_1 - \mu)^2 + \dots + (X_{22646} - \mu)^2}{N}}$

pop parameters

$s = \sqrt{\frac{(X_2 - \bar{X})^2 + \dots + (X_{22600} - \bar{X})^2}{n-1}}$

Sample statistics

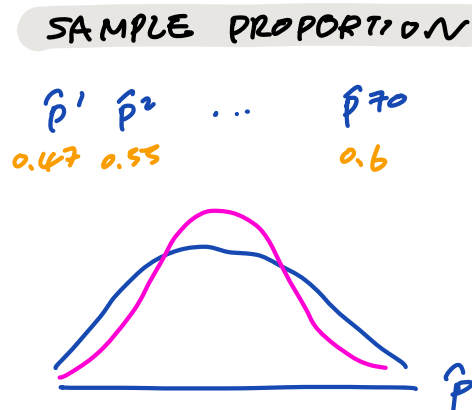
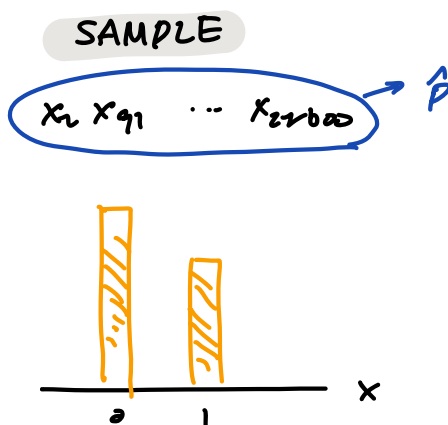
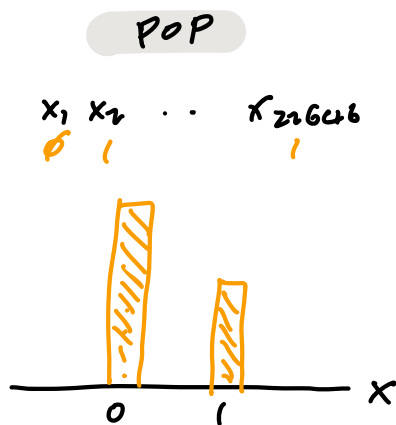
sd of $\bar{X} = \frac{\sigma}{\sqrt{n}}$

if $\bar{X}$ is normally distributed

- or
- ① pop $\sim N$
 - ② $n \geq 30$

Q2 Morning person?

$X = \begin{cases} 1 & (\text{yes}) \\ 0 & (\text{no}) \end{cases}$



PROPORTION $P = \frac{X}{N}$

yes

$\hat{p} = \frac{X}{N}$

mean of $\hat{p} = P$

sd of $\hat{p} = \sqrt{\frac{P(1-P)}{n}}$

if $\hat{p}$ is normally distributed

- ① $np \geq 15$ AND ② $n(1-p) \geq 15$

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Week 7. Statistical Inference: Confidence Intervals

Point estimate: A single number that is our “best guess” for the parameter.

Interval estimate: An interval of numbers that is believed to contain the actual value of the parameter.

Confidence Interval: **Point estimate** $\pm$ **Margin of Error**

Margin of Error: Width of an interval measured by s.d. of the sampling distribution.

Population Proportion (p)	
A 100(1 - α)% CI for the population proportion (p)	$= \hat{p} \pm z_{\frac{\alpha}{2}}(\text{se})$
A 95% CI for the population proportion (p)	$= \hat{p} \pm \mathbf{1.96} \sqrt{\frac{\hat{p}(1-\hat{p})}{n}}$
A 99% CI for the population proportion (p)	$= \hat{p} \pm \mathbf{2.58} \sqrt{\frac{\hat{p}(1-\hat{p})}{n}}$
$n\hat{p} \geq 15$ and $n(1 - \hat{p}) \geq 15$ conditions should hold!	

Population Mean	
A 100(1 - α)% CI for the population mean (μ)	$= \bar{x} \pm t_{\frac{\alpha}{2}, df}(\text{se})$, where $df = n - 1$
A 95% CI for the population mean (μ)	$= \bar{x} \pm \mathbf{t_{0.025, df}} \frac{s}{\sqrt{n}}$
A 99% CI for the population mean (μ)	$= \bar{x} \pm \mathbf{t_{0.005, df}} \frac{s}{\sqrt{n}}$

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Week 8. Statistical Inference: Significance Tests

A **CI** estimates a range of plausible values for an unknown population parameter.

A **significance test** checks the plausibility of statements (i.e., hypotheses) about a population parameter.

A significance test for a...

Population Proportion p	Population Mean μ
1. State H_0 and H_a.	
$H_0: p = p_0$ $H_a: p \neq p_0$ (for a two-tailed test)	$H_0: \mu = \mu_0$ $H_a: \mu \neq \mu_0$ (for a two-tailed test)
2. Choose a significance level α (usually 0.05)	
3. Calculate a test statistic (z-score or t-score)	
$z = \frac{\hat{p} - p_0}{sd(p_0)}$, where $sd(p_0) = \sqrt{\frac{p_0(1-p_0)}{n}}$	If the <u>population s.d.</u> σ is known, $z = \frac{\bar{x} - \mu_0}{sd(\mu_0)}$, where $sd(\mu_0) = \frac{\sigma}{\sqrt{n}}$ If σ is unknown and, we use <u>sample s.d.</u> s , $t = \frac{\bar{x} - \mu_0}{se(\mu_0)}$, where $se(\mu_0) = \frac{s}{\sqrt{n}}$
4. Find a p-value (for two-sided tests)	
p-value = $P(z \geq \text{the test statistic } z)$	If the test statistic is z, p-value = $P(z \geq \text{the test statistic } z)$ If the test statistic is t, p-value = $P(t \geq \text{the test statistic } t)$ using t-distribution with $df = n - 1$
5. Make a conclusion Reject H_0 if p-value $\leq \alpha$	

H_0 is a statement that a population parameter takes **a particular value**.

H_a is a statement that a population parameter falls in some **alternative range of values**.

A **significance level (α)** is the **cutoff point** that we reject H_0 . We reject H_0 if p-value $\leq \alpha$.

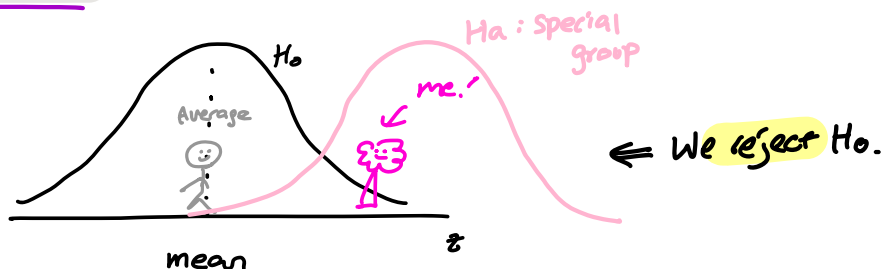
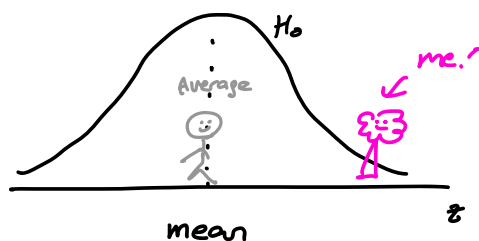
A **test statistic** describes how far a point estimate falls from the parameter value given in the null hypothesis. i.e., It is the distance between a sample statistic and a parameter measured in s.d. The **larger** the test statistic (in magnitude), the **more unlikely your sample statistic value came from the null distribution**.

A **p-value** measures how unusual the data would be if H_0 were true. i.e., It is the probability that a test statistic equals the observed value or even more extreme one. The **smaller** the p-value, the **stronger the evidence is against H_0** .

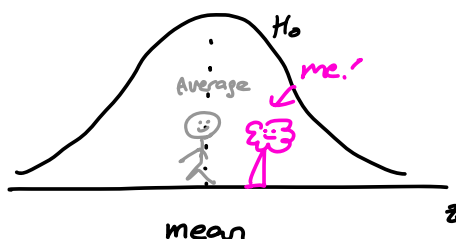
H_0 : You're just like the other people.

H_a : I'm special! I don't belong to a reg (normal) group.

CASE 1



CASE 2

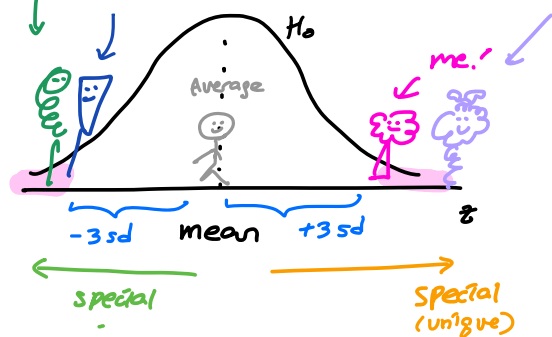


⇒ We cannot reject H_0 .

more unique

unique as much as I am

who is even more special (??) / unique than me.?



① Calculate the test statistic.

② Calculate the p-value

the prob. that you find someone like me, or someone who is even more special / weird than me in the normal group

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Week 9. Regression Analysis

Correlation Coefficient

- Population $\rho_{xy} = \frac{\sigma_{xy}}{\sigma_x \sigma_y}$
- Sample $r = \frac{\text{cov}(X,Y)}{s_x s_y}$, where $\text{cov}(X,Y) = \frac{\sum (x_i - \bar{x})(y_i - \bar{y})}{n-1}$

If we rearrange, it can be also written as the following:

$$r = \frac{1}{n-1} \sum \left(\frac{x_i - \bar{x}}{s_x} \right) \left(\frac{y_i - \bar{y}}{s_y} \right) = \frac{1}{n-1} \sum (z_{xi} \times z_{yi})$$

Don't panic. Covariance is a general form of a variance: $s_x^2 = \frac{\sum (x_i - \bar{x})^2}{n-1}$

- Correlation coefficient is between -1 and 1.
- Two variables have strong linear association if the absolute value of r is greater than 0.5.

Simple Regression Model $E[y|x] = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x$

- Interpretation:
 - $E[y|x]$: Expected value of y given x
 - β_0 (Intercept): The expected value of y when x=0
 - β_1 (Slope): The change in expected value of y when x increases by one unit.
- Error term: Actual – Expected value $\Rightarrow u_i = y_i - E[y|x]$

Most of the time, we don't know the true population parameters β_0 and β_1 . Therefore, we estimate them with a sample. Population parameters: β_0 and $\beta_1 \Leftrightarrow$ Point estimates: $\widehat{\beta}_0$ and $\widehat{\beta}_1$

We use **Ordinary Least Squares (OLS)** to estimate $\widehat{\beta}_0$ and $\widehat{\beta}_1$. OLS is a method that guesses the unknown parameters by minimizing the sum of squared residuals.

Residual = Actual – Predicted value $\Rightarrow e_i = y_i - \widehat{y}_i$, where $\widehat{y}_i = \widehat{\beta}_0 + \widehat{\beta}_1 x_i$

$$\text{OLS estimator: } \min \sum e_i^2 = \min \sum (y_i - \widehat{y}_i)^2$$

If we solve this,

$$\begin{aligned} \widehat{\beta}_1 &= \frac{\sum (x_i - \bar{x})(y_i - \bar{y})}{\sum (x_i - \bar{x})^2} = \frac{\text{cov}(x, y)}{s_x^2} = r \frac{s_y}{s_x} \\ \widehat{\beta}_0 &= \bar{y} - \widehat{\beta}_1 \bar{x} \end{aligned}$$

We can check how our model fits well, i.e. how much our model explains the variation in the y values using **R-squared**. In a simple regression model, $R^2 = r^2$, where r = correlation coefficient.